Portland Public Schools
Update on the role of the Audit Committee in the RFP process for external auditors
April 15, 2025

As discussed in the Audit Committee's December meeting, the district's current contract for Financial Auditing Services with Talbot, Korvola & Warwick ended on March 31, 2025. The Finance Department developed a Request for Proposal (RFP) for a five-year contract for April 1, 2025 - March 31, 2030, with five additional annual contract extensions that can be used at the district's discretion through March 31, 2035. The RFP was issued on October 31, and proposals were due on January 8, 2025.

Here is the timeline for the RFP process:

ACTIVITY	DATE
Issuance of Request for Proposal	November 1, 2024
Deadline for Questions or Clarifications	December 3, 2024
Final Addenda Deadline	December 18, 2025
Proposals Due	January 8, 2025
Notice of Intent to Award	February 20, 2025
Board Approval Date	April 8, 2025
Anticipated Contract Start	April 9, 2025
Project Completion Date	March 31, 2030

Staff recommends the following composition of the evaluation panel to review and score the proposals:

- 2 PPS Staff Members- Melissa Ensminger, Michelle Morrison
- 1 PPS Internal Auditor- Janise Hansen
- 1 PPS Board Member- Patte Sullivan
- 1 Audit Committee Community Member- Caroline Zavitkovski

The District received a single proposal from Talbot, Korvola & Warwick, LLP (TKW) that was reviewed by the evaluation panel above and met the requirements of the RFP. The number of firms that provide services in Oregon has declined due to increased costs and recent additions to the process as required by federal, state, and local/internal requirements. The firm has received Notice of Award and a schedule for both preliminary and final audit activities for FY25.